

The knight's special geometry

Foundations

THE IDEA

A knight changes one coordinate by two and the other by one. It jumps over intervening pieces but cannot land on a friendly piece. It changes square color on every move, which helps you check a visualized route.

WORKED EXAMPLE

An unobstructed knight on d4 reaches b3, b5, c2, c6, e2, e6, f3, and f5. Notice that all eight destinations have the opposite color from d4. A knight on a1 has only b3 and c2.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Can a knight on d4 attack a queen on f5 despite a pawn on e4?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Yes. The pawn does not block a knight jump. Whether capturing the queen is legal still depends on whether the knight is pinned to its king.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

For knight threats, check landing squares rather than lines.